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POLITICS OF EUROPEAN INTEGRATION: CLASSROOM EXERCISE

Lobbying the Commission on the Glyphosate Licence

A 45-minute interest-group lobbying simulation in which four rival lobby groups pitch a mock Commissioner and edit a draft policy proposal on renewing the glyphosate licence.

Topic tags: EU lobbying · interest groups · agenda-setting · Commission policymaking · coalition-building · evidence and advocacy

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Abstract

This simulation puts students inside the lobbying that surrounds a live European Commission decision: whether to renew the licence for the herbicide glyphosate for a further ten years. Four teams each represent a real organisation with a stake in the outcome, two arguing for renewal (Bayer, the manufacturer, and Copa-Cogeca, the farmers' and cooperatives' association) and two arguing against (Corporate Europe Observatory, a lobby-transparency campaign group, and Greenpeace, an environmental network). A fifth team plays the Commissioner for Health and Food Safety and a small staff, who hear each group's pitch and control the text of the proposal. Groups assign internal roles, gather evidence to back their stance, may form coalitions with like-minded lobbies, and send a lead negotiator to a short pitch meeting before editing a supplied draft proposal to reflect their position. The Commission then synthesises the submissions into a single proposal that would, in the real procedure, go to the European Parliament for a vote. The exercise teaches how interest groups seek to shape EU policy, how evidence is marshalled and contested in advocacy, and why privileged access and coalition strength matter as much as the merits of an argument.

Learning outcomes

By the end of this exercise students will be able to:

- Explain how organised interest groups attempt to influence Commission policymaking, and why access, coalitions and framing matter alongside the strength of the evidence.
- Distinguish the strategies of business lobbies, producer associations and public-interest NGOs, and identify where their interests align and diverge.
- Assemble and present evidence in support of a defined position under time pressure, and anticipate how opponents will counter it.
- Evaluate critically the balance of influence in EU lobbying and the transparency concerns it raises, drawing on the difference between corporate and NGO access.

At a glance

Duration	45 minutes of simulation (with a 5-minute buffer), plus 15–20 minutes debrief
Class size	20–35 students: four lobby groups of 4–6, plus a 2–4 person Commission team
Room setup	One room with moveable seating; four group tables plus a separate table for the Commission; projector or screen for the introductory slides
Materials needed	Introductory slides on EU lobbying; four lobby-group briefs; a Commission role brief; the draft policy proposal template (one editable copy per group); a shared folder or drive where groups submit their edited proposals; internet access for live research
Instructor prep time	45–60 minutes (allocate groups, print or share briefs, set up the shared folder, prepare the slides)
Student prep time	15–20 minutes reading their brief and the draft proposal in advance (optional; the design also works cold)

Pre-class preparation

For the instructor

- Divide the class into four lobby groups and one Commission team. The four lobby groups are Bayer and Copa-Cogeca (both pro-renewal) and Corporate Europe Observatory and Greenpeace (both anti-renewal). Aim for balanced groups of 4–6; the Commission team needs only 2–4.
- Distribute each group's brief (Appendix B) and a copy of the draft policy proposal template (Appendix B, final handout) at least a day before class if you want students to prepare, or hand them out at the start if running cold. Give the Commission team its own role brief (Appendix A1).
- Set up a shared folder or drive (for example a shared cloud folder) with one editable copy of the draft proposal for each lobby group. The groups edit their own copy during the session and leave it where the Commission team can read all four. Create your own folder; do not rely on any pre-existing student link.
- Open the session with the introductory slides on EU lobbying (Appendix A2), which set the theme: the imbalance between corporate and NGO access to Commission officials.
- Where possible, take students' confidence into account when allocating groups, so that quieter students are not all concentrated in one team and every group can field a lead negotiator willing to pitch.

For students

- Read your group's brief and the draft policy proposal beforehand. Come ready to argue your assigned position, setting aside your own views about glyphosate.
- Note which other group is your natural ally (the other pro-renewal or anti-renewal team) and think about how you might coordinate.

Role allocation within each lobby group

Each lobby group divides itself into four sub-roles. In smaller groups one student can hold two; in larger groups the coalition and research roles can be shared.

- **Lead negotiator:** prepares and delivers the group's pitch to the Commissioner, and carries the feedback back.
- **Researcher:** finds and checks the evidence that supports the group's stance.
- **Policy drafter:** edits the group's copy of the draft proposal to reflect the position and the evidence.
- **Coalition builders:** reach out to the like-minded group to share information and coordinate arguments.

Session plan

The simulation runs to 45 minutes, with a 5-minute buffer built in because the pitch round often overruns. The scenario: the Commissioner for Health and Food Safety has tabled a proposal to renew the glyphosate licence for another ten years, and the four lobby groups are competing to shape the final text before it goes forward.

Time	Phase	What happens
0:00–0:05	Introduction	Introduce the exercise as a lobbying simulation: each group represents an interest group trying to influence the policy coming out of the Commission. Show the introductory slides (Appendix A2) on corporate versus NGO access. Run through the structure, the rules and the pitch timing below.
0:05–0:25	Preparation and research	Groups get familiar with the draft proposal and their assigned position, assign the four internal sub-roles, and research evidence for their stance (trustworthy websites and reputable news reporting on research are enough, given the time). Groups may build alliances with the like-minded group to share information and coordinate. Each group starts drafting its pitch, but should be strategic about what it reveals, since the other groups will hear it and may counter it.
0:25–0:33	Pitch meeting	Each group's lead negotiator meets the Commissioner and staff and delivers a pitch of about 1.5 minutes on why their arguments should shape the final proposal. The Commissioner gives brief feedback after each pitch. Negotiators who are not speaking should listen closely, since they may need to counter a rival's argument in their own draft. Group members not at the meeting keep working on the proposal.
0:33–0:40	Finalising the proposal	Lead negotiators return with the Commissioner's feedback. Each group finalises its edited draft proposal, incorporating the feedback and its evidence, and

Time	Phase	What happens
		submits it to the shared folder for the Commission to read.
0:40–0:45	Commission synthesis	The lobby groups take a short break. The Commissioner and staff read the four submissions and assemble a single final policy proposal that reflects the strongest and best-evidenced arguments, then present it to the class to close the activity.

Rules and mechanics

- **Pitch length.** Each lead negotiator gets about 1.5 minutes. Keep to it; four pitches plus feedback fill the eight-minute slot.
- **Evidence.** Because of the time limit, references to trustworthy websites and reputable news outlets reporting on research are acceptable; students do not need to read primary studies in full. Stronger, better-sourced evidence carries more weight with the Commissioner.
- **Coalitions.** Groups may ally with the other group on their side to share evidence and coordinate arguments. Coalitions are optional but rewarded: a coordinated pair is harder to counter.
- **The Commission decides.** The Commission team is not neutral scenery. It weighs the pitches and the written submissions and decides what goes into the final proposal (see Appendix A1). Its synthesis is the outcome of the exercise.

Debrief and reflection

Allow 15–20 minutes. The debrief is where the lobbying lessons land; the pitch round is fun but the learning is in the reflection, so do not let it be squeezed. Group the questions as follows.

On strategy and influence: surface how the groups tried to win.

- How did your group decide what to put in the pitch and what to hold back? Did that calculation pay off?
- Did coalitions form? Did being part of a coalition change what you could achieve, and did the Commission treat a coordinated pair differently?
- Looking at the final proposal, whose arguments actually made it in? Why do you think those won out?

On evidence and framing: surface how evidence is used in advocacy.

- The scientific evidence on glyphosate is genuinely contested. How did each side use that uncertainty to its advantage?
- Did any group make claims that went beyond what its evidence could support? How should a Commissioner handle that?
- How did the same facts get framed differently by the pro- and anti-renewal groups?

On the Commission and access: surface the institutional theory.

- The opening slides showed that most Commission lobby meetings are with corporate interests. Did that imbalance show up in the room, and why?
- As the Commission team: which pitches were most persuasive, and was persuasiveness the same thing as being right?
- Is a process where organised groups pitch a Commissioner a good way to make policy? What does it do well, and where are the risks to the public interest?

On the bigger picture: connect to the real case.

- The real glyphosate licence was renewed for ten years in 2023 despite sustained opposition. Does the outcome of your simulation help explain why?
- What would make EU lobbying more transparent or more balanced? Would those reforms have changed your group's strategy?

Assessment suggestions

The exercise works well ungraded, but if assessment is wanted, keep it light:

- A short individual reflection (300–500 words) answering two or three of the debrief questions, or comparing the group's strategy with how real lobbying on this file worked.
- A participation mark for staying in role and contributing to the pitch or the draft.
- A brief group note (from the policy drafter) explaining the two or three changes they made to the draft proposal and the evidence behind them.
- For the Commission team: a short written justification of what they included in the final proposal and why, which doubles as a marking record.

Adaptation notes

- **Scaling.** With fewer students, run three groups (drop one of the pro- or anti-renewal pair) and shrink the Commission team to two. With more, add a second manufacturer or a consumer-protection NGO, or split each group so two students share the researcher and coalition roles rather than enlarging teams beyond six.
- **Difficulty.** To sharpen the contest, require every claim in a pitch to carry a citation, and let the Commission challenge unsupported claims on the spot. To make coalition dynamics harder, introduce a small conflict of interest between the two allies (for example, Bayer and Copa-Cogeca disagree over who pays for stricter application rules).
- **Realism.** Add a final Parliament vote: after the Commission presents its synthesised proposal, have the class vote as MEPs, which mirrors the real path of a renewal decision. Or introduce a second Commission portfolio (Agriculture, or Environment) with a different priority, so the lobby groups must lobby two officials with different concerns.
- **Online delivery.** Put each group in its own breakout room, run the pitch meeting in the main room with lead negotiators sharing screen, and use a shared drive for the four proposal copies and the Commission's synthesis.

- **Different topic.** The same structure fits any live EU regulatory decision with organised industry and NGO stakeholders: a pesticide or chemical approval, a data-protection or AI rule, an emissions standard, a food-labelling regulation. Swap the substance, the groups and the draft proposal; keep the pitch-and-edit mechanic.

Appendix A: Instructor materials

A1. Commission role brief (facilitator's key document)

The original activity assumed the instructor would play the Commissioner and left the role undocumented. This brief fills that gap. Give it to whoever plays the Commission (the instructor, a teaching assistant, or a small student team) and use it to run the pitch meeting and judge the proposals consistently.

Who you are. You are the Commissioner for Health and Food Safety and a small staff. You have tabled a proposal to renew the glyphosate licence for ten years (Appendix B, draft proposal template). You are the agenda-setter: the four lobby groups are trying to move your text, and you decide what the final proposal says. You are not neutral scenery and you are not a judge awarding points; you are a decision-maker weighing competing pressures.

Before the pitches. Read the four group briefs so you know each group's stance and likely arguments. Decide privately how open you are to change: a good default is that you lean towards renewal (as the real Commission did) but are genuinely willing to add safeguards, transition measures or research commitments if a group makes a strong, well-evidenced case.

Running the pitch meeting (0:25–0:33). Hear the four lead negotiators in turn, roughly 1.5 minutes each. Keep time firmly. After each pitch give 20–30 seconds of feedback, which is the point of the meeting: tell the group what landed, what was weak, and what evidence would strengthen their draft. Useful prompts:

- “What is your single strongest piece of evidence, and where is it from?”
- “Your opponents will say X. How do you answer that?”
- “You are asking me to change the text. Change it to say what, exactly?”

Push groups towards concrete, draftable asks rather than general positions. Let the non-speaking negotiators hear everything, since the value of the round is that each group learns what it must counter.

Judging the written submissions (0:40–0:45). Read all four edited proposals. Weigh them on:

- **Evidence quality:** is the claim sourced, and is the source credible? Discount confident claims with no support.
- **Concreteness:** does the group propose specific, workable changes to the text (a transition period, buffer strips, usage limits, research funding) rather than just restating its stance?
- **Responsiveness:** did the group anticipate and answer the other side, or ignore it?

Building the final proposal. Assemble a single text that keeps the strongest, best-supported elements from across the submissions. A realistic outcome is not a clean win for either side: the real 2023 renewal went ahead but with conditions and monitoring. A synthesis that renews the licence while adding safeguards, phased review or research commitments drawn from the anti-renewal groups usually reflects the room best and gives the richest debrief. Present it to the class and explain briefly why you included what you did; that explanation is also your marking record if you are assessing the Commission team.

A2. Introductory slides: lobbying in the EU

Open with a short framing on the balance of lobbying influence in Brussels, to set up the theme that access is uneven. The original used one core statistic, which you can present or recreate:

- An analysis of 4,318 lobby meetings declared by the top tier of Commission officials over one seven-month period found that more than 75% were with corporate lobbyists, compared with around 18% with NGOs, 4% with think tanks and 2% with local authorities. Some of the most active corporate lobbyists at that level each declared EU lobby budgets of several million euro a year.

Attribute the figure to its source rather than reproducing any slide verbatim. The underlying data and framing come from Transparency International and Corporate Europe Observatory; provide the links below and let students see the original reporting.

- Transparency International (2015) ‘Lobby meetings with EU policy-makers dominated by corporate interests’. Available at: <https://www.transparency.org/en/press/lobby-meetings-with-eu-policy-makers-dominated-by-corporate-interests>
- Corporate Europe Observatory (2022) ‘A ranking of lobbying activities: who spends most?’. Available at: <https://corporateeurope.org/en/2022/09/ranking-lobbying-activities-who-spends-most>
- The EU Transparency Register (the public register of organisations lobbying the EU institutions) is a good live resource to show in class: <https://transparency-register.europa.eu>

A3. Background on the glyphosate file (for the instructor)

Brief context so you can steer the debrief and correct in-character exaggerations:

- Glyphosate is a widely used broad-spectrum herbicide, the active ingredient in Bayer’s Roundup (originally Monsanto’s; Bayer acquired Monsanto in 2018).
- Its safety is genuinely contested. In 2015 the International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC) classified glyphosate as “probably carcinogenic to humans”. EU agencies reached a different view: the European Food Safety Authority (EFSA) and the European Chemicals Agency (ECHA) found no critical concern that would bar approval. Students will cite both sides; the disagreement is the point.
- In 2017 a European Citizens’ Initiative, “Ban glyphosate”, collected over a million signatures.
- In November 2023, after member states failed to reach a qualified majority either way, the Commission renewed the glyphosate approval for ten years, with some conditions. Knowing the real outcome lets you compare it with the class result in the debrief.

Note that the pro-renewal briefs, in character, present some contested industry claims about glyphosate’s safety as settled fact. That is deliberate role-play, not an instructor endorsement; flag it in the debrief when you discuss how evidence gets used in advocacy.

A4. Further reading

- Kliver, H. (2013) *Lobbying in the European Union: Interest Groups, Lobbying Coalitions, and Policy Change*. Oxford University Press. On how coalitions and information shape lobbying success.
- Dür, A., Bernhagen, P. and Marshall, D. (2015) ‘Interest Group Success in the European Union’, *Comparative Political Studies*, 48(8), pp. 951–983. On when and why groups win.
- Coen, D. and Richardson, J. (eds) (2009) *Lobbying the European Union: Institutions, Actors, and Issues*. Oxford University Press. A broad overview of EU interest representation.

- Corporate Europe Observatory, ongoing reporting on lobbying and the glyphosate file (corporateeurope.org). Useful for the campaigning-NGO perspective.
- European Commission, glyphosate approval pages:
https://food.ec.europa.eu/plants/pesticides/approval-active-substances/renewal-approval/glyphosate_en

Appendix B: Student handouts and role briefs

Each brief and the proposal template start on a new page. Give each lobby group only its own brief plus one copy of the draft proposal template; give the Commission team the role brief in Appendix A1.

Bayer

Your group represents Bayer, lobbying the Commissioner and the wider EU on the glyphosate renewal.

Who you are. Bayer (Bayer AG) is a German multinational operating in life sciences, especially healthcare and agriculture. It is one of the largest pharmaceutical, biotech and agribusiness companies in the world. In 2018 Bayer acquired the American agribusiness Monsanto, the developer of the glyphosate-based herbicide Roundup, which is used to support crop cultivation across the agricultural industry worldwide.

The decision. The Commissioner has tabled a proposal to renew the glyphosate licence for another ten years. Glyphosate is an active ingredient in weed killers, used widely in industry, agriculture, forestry and private gardens; Roundup is the best-known product. Its safety is contested and the scientific evidence is not conclusive. In 2017 over a million citizens signed the “Ban glyphosate” European Citizens’ Initiative; in July 2021 an EU assessment group reported that glyphosate meets the approval criteria for human health and recommended its approval as an active substance in plant protection products.

Your position. Bayer strongly supports renewal. Your central argument: glyphosate is a necessary tool in modern agriculture that helps farmers deliver high-quality products at prices EU citizens can afford, and it is safe when used as directed. Build the strongest evidence-based case you can; the better your argument, the more likely the Commissioner is to keep your priorities in the final proposal.

Points you can build on (find sources to support them):

- Glyphosate has been approved and used for around 50 years across farming, food production, vegetation management and gardening.
- It helps secure food supply as demand grows: farmers can lose a large share of crops to weeds, pests and disease, and glyphosate reduces that loss.
- It controls growers’ costs and can support lower-till farming, which conserves water and reduces tillage-related emissions.
- Many national and international regulators have judged glyphosate safe for humans when used correctly, and EU agencies (EFSA and ECHA) found no scientific or legal justification for a ban.

What you can offer. To make renewal easier to accept, you can propose safeguards: regular transparent reporting on how glyphosate is used and its effects; stricter application rules (protective equipment for workers, minimum distances from homes); and support for research into safer future alternatives, provided any alternative is cost-effective and does not burden citizens with higher prices.

Your tasks.

- Assign the four sub-roles: lead negotiator, researcher, policy drafter, coalition builders.
- Consider allying with Copa-Cogeca, the other pro-renewal group, to coordinate arguments.
- Prepare a 1.5-minute pitch for the Commissioner. Be strategic: rivals will hear it.
- After feedback, edit your copy of the draft proposal to reflect your position and evidence, and submit it to the shared folder.

Copa-Cogeca

Your group represents Copa-Cogeca, lobbying the Commissioner and the wider EU on the glyphosate renewal.

Who you are. Copa-Cogeca is the united voice of European farmers and their cooperatives, representing more than 22 million farmers and around 22,000 cooperatives across the EU. Your work is to represent farmers' interests in the laws and policies that affect farming, and to expect European leaders to support and facilitate the farming industry in return for the high-quality food farmers produce.

The decision. The Commissioner has tabled a proposal to renew the glyphosate licence for another ten years. Glyphosate is a herbicide used widely in agriculture, industry, forestry and gardens; it improves crop yields by giving crops better access to water and sunlight. Its safety is contested and the evidence is not conclusive. In 2017 over a million citizens signed the “Ban glyphosate” European Citizens’ Initiative; in July 2021 an EU assessment group reported that glyphosate meets the approval criteria for human health and recommended its approval as an active substance in plant protection products.

Your position. Copa-Cogeca supports renewal. Your central argument: glyphosate is a necessary tool in agriculture that helps farmers deliver high-quality products affordable for EU citizens, and it is effective and inexpensive. Build the strongest evidence-based case you can.

Points you can build on (find sources to support them):

- Affordability and food security: glyphosate raises crop yields, helps hold food prices down and supports stable production. Recent supply shocks have shown the value of European self-reliance in food.
- The scientific picture is not settled: EU authorities have judged glyphosate acceptable, and there is no consensus that it is carcinogenic.
- Practicality: proposed “natural” substitutes such as vinegar are not realistic alternatives for large-scale production across millions of farms.

What you can offer. To make renewal easier to accept, you can propose: funding for further efficiency and safety research; an education campaign on correct use; and practical protective measures, for example buffer strips of several metres between treated and neighbouring fields and specialised equipment to cut spray drift substantially.

Your tasks.

- Assign the four sub-roles: lead negotiator, researcher, policy drafter, coalition builders.
- Consider allying with Bayer, the other pro-renewal group, to coordinate arguments.
- Prepare a 1.5-minute pitch for the Commissioner. Be strategic: rivals will hear it.
- After feedback, edit your copy of the draft proposal to reflect your position and evidence, and submit it to the shared folder.

Corporate Europe Observatory

Your group represents Corporate Europe Observatory (CEO), lobbying the Commissioner and the wider EU on the glyphosate renewal.

Who you are. Corporate Europe Observatory is a research and campaign group that exposes and challenges the privileged access and influence corporations and their lobbyists enjoy in EU policymaking. You screen upcoming EU legislation for social injustice, economic inequality and environmental harm. You are a small team, working independently of funding from EU institutions and corporations. You backed the “Stop glyphosate” European Citizens’ Initiative that collected more than a million signatures.

The decision. The Commissioner has tabled a proposal to renew the glyphosate licence for another ten years. Glyphosate is an active ingredient in weed killers, used widely in agriculture, industry, forestry and gardens; Roundup is the best-known product. Its safety is contested and the evidence is not conclusive. In 2017 over a million citizens signed the “Ban glyphosate” European Citizens’ Initiative; in July 2021 an EU assessment group reported that glyphosate meets the approval criteria for human health and recommended its approval as an active substance.

Your position. CEO is strongly against renewal and wants a complete ban, arguing that the long- and short-term consequences have not been assessed impartially and that corporate influence has shaped the process. You point to research linking glyphosate to cancer and to ecosystem damage.

Points you can build on (find sources to support them):

- **Environmental harm:** independent research points to negative effects on bees, soil health, aquatic life and biodiversity. Glyphosate can persist in soil for long periods (studies report a very wide range), and repeated use may impair its breakdown and raise the risk of groundwater contamination.
- **Human health:** the herbicide has been linked to genotoxicity, disruption of the gut microbiome, possible neurotoxicity, liver damage and endocrine effects. It can irritate skin, eyes and the airways, and heavy long-term users may face respiratory effects. The IARC has classified glyphosate as “probably carcinogenic to humans”, and a US EPA evaluation noted an association with myeloma and Non-Hodgkin lymphoma.
- **Alternatives exist:** several non-selective herbicides (for example diquat, pelargonic acid and glufosinate) and organic options such as vinegar and botanical oils can control many weeds, though most act on contact rather than through the roots.

What you can offer. If a full immediate ban is not achievable, you can propose: a ten-year transition period phasing glyphosate out while covering the cost of switching to greener alternatives; strict limits on where it may be used (away from homes, water sources and wildlife refuges); a ban on domestic (household) use; subsidies for organic alternatives; and a green scheme funding research into safer substitutes.

Your tasks.

- Assign the four sub-roles: lead negotiator, researcher, policy drafter, coalition builders.
- Consider allying with Greenpeace, the other anti-renewal group, to coordinate arguments.

- Prepare a 1.5-minute pitch for the Commissioner. Be strategic: rivals will hear it.
- After feedback, edit your copy of the draft proposal to reflect your position and evidence, and submit it to the shared folder.

Greenpeace

Your group represents Greenpeace, lobbying the Commissioner and the wider EU on the glyphosate renewal.

Who you are. Greenpeace is a global, independent campaigning network working to protect the environment and promote peace. It preserves its independence by refusing donations from governments, the EU, businesses and political parties. It has millions of supporters and operates through independent national and regional organisations in dozens of countries.

The decision. The Commissioner has tabled a proposal to renew the glyphosate licence for another ten years. Glyphosate is a herbicide used widely in agriculture, industry, forestry and gardens. Its safety is contested and the evidence is not conclusive. In 2017 over a million citizens signed the “Ban glyphosate” European Citizens’ Initiative; in July 2021 an EU assessment group reported that glyphosate meets the approval criteria for human health and recommended its approval as an active substance.

Your position. Greenpeace is strongly against renewal and wants a complete ban, citing links between glyphosate and serious harm to human health and to pollinators. Your central argument focuses on neurological health effects (including possible links to Parkinson’s disease and other neurological conditions) and on the damage to insect pollinators.

Points you can build on (find sources to support them):

- Pollinators: pesticide use is a suspected driver of pollinator decline. Experimental work suggests glyphosate can impair learning in bumblebees, which argues for broader risk assessments that test effects on pollinators’ cognition, not just acute toxicity.
- Ecosystem toxicity: glyphosate residues turn up in soil, water and food, and toxic effects have been observed across a wide range of organisms, from earthworms and aquatic life to birds, alongside genotoxic and hormonal effects reported in higher vertebrates.
- Human neurological effects: research points to oxidative stress, neuroinflammation and mitochondrial dysfunction linked to glyphosate exposure, with possible behavioural and motor consequences that deserve much more study.
- Regulatory precedent: France restricted glyphosate where non-chemical alternatives exist, and ECHA has confirmed a hazard classification for serious eye damage and toxicity to aquatic life.

What you can offer. If a full immediate ban is not achievable, you can propose: a slow phase-out of glyphosate; a large increase in research funding into pesticides’ neurological effects and into safer alternatives, and into Parkinson’s disease prevention; and support for lower-risk alternatives (for example acetic-acid-based vinegar treatments or plant-derived options such as citrus-seed extract), while tightening regulation to limit further use of potentially harmful chemicals.

Your tasks.

- Assign the four sub-roles: lead negotiator, researcher, policy drafter, coalition builders.
- Consider allying with Corporate Europe Observatory, the other anti-renewal group, to coordinate arguments.
- Prepare a 1.5-minute pitch for the Commissioner. Be strategic: rivals will hear it.

- After feedback, edit your copy of the draft proposal to reflect your position and evidence, and submit it to the shared folder.

Draft policy proposal (one editable copy per group)

Give each lobby group its own copy of this template. The Introduction and Background are provided and should not be changed. Each group completes the Rationale, Proposed measures and Conclusion to argue its own position, backed by the evidence it gathers. The Commission collects all four completed versions and synthesises them into a single final proposal.

Policy Proposal: Renewal of the Glyphosate Licence for 10 Years

Agenda-setter: the European Commissioner for Health and Food Safety.

Introduction

Glyphosate is a widely used herbicide in the European Union, relied upon in modern agricultural practice. This proposal concerns whether to renew the licence for glyphosate for another ten years, weighing continued availability for agricultural use against safety and environmental standards.

Background

In 2017, more than one million citizens signed the “Ban glyphosate” European Citizens’ Initiative (European Union, 2017). In July 2021, the Assessment Group on Glyphosate (AGG) provided a report to the European Commission concluding that glyphosate meets the approval criteria for human health and recommending its approval as an active substance in plant protection products. The current licence is due to expire, which requires a timely decision to avoid disruption to agricultural practice (European Commission, 2024).

Rationale *(complete with 2–3 points supporting your group’s position, each with a source)*

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Proposed measures *(complete with 2–3 concrete changes or safeguards your group wants in the final text)*

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Conclusion *(write a short paragraph of 3–4 lines that states your group’s recommendation and why the Commission should adopt it)*

Note for groups: cite your sources beside each point (a link to a reputable website, agency or news report is enough). The Commission will weigh how well-evidenced and how concrete each submission is, so specific, sourced asks carry more weight than general statements.